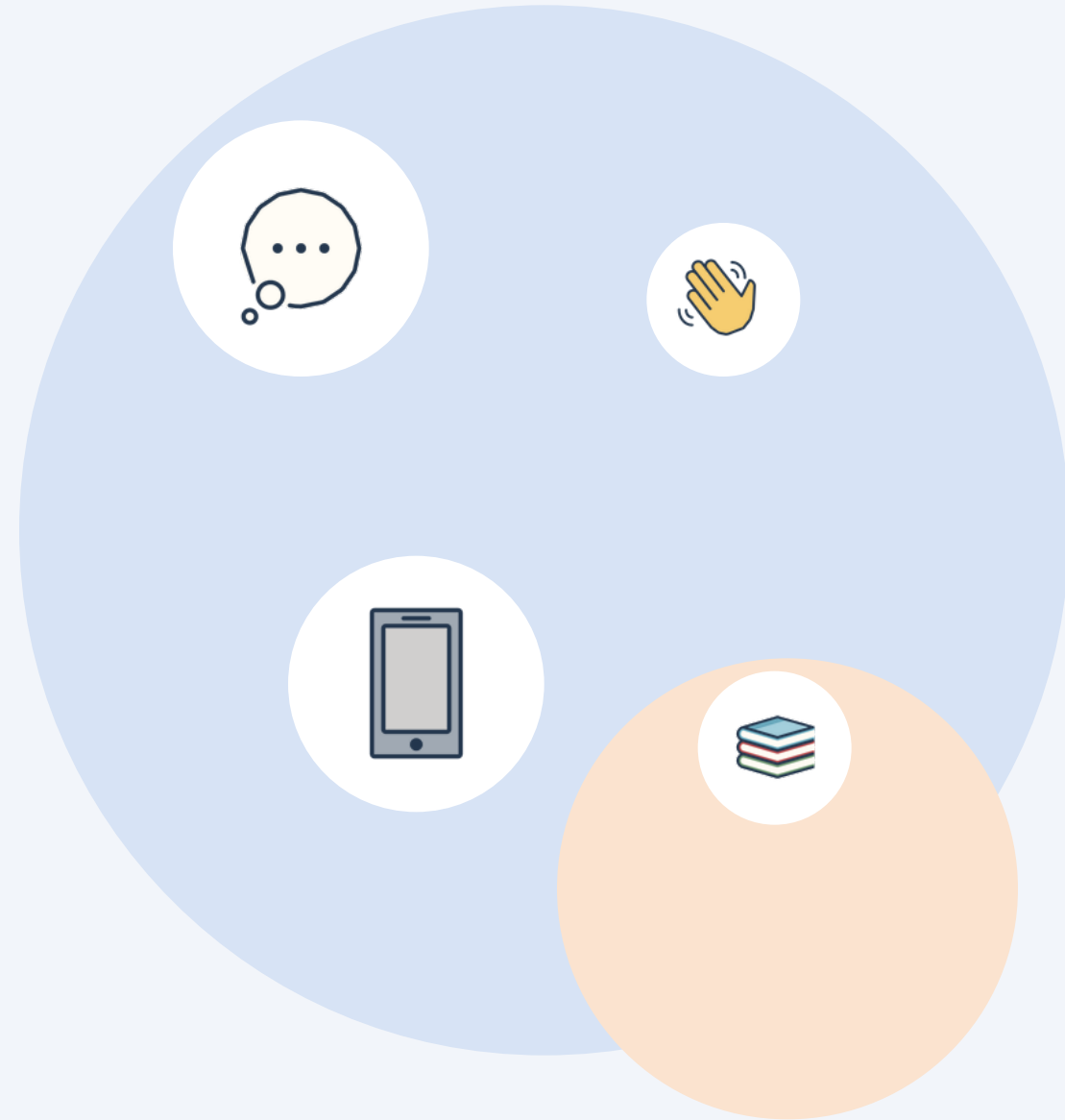


THERAPIST SPOTLIGHT

Speech-Language Therapy & Communication

How speech-language pathologists help autistic and ADHD people connect and be understood.



What an SLP works on



Language

Understanding words and sentences, and expressing needs and ideas.



Social communication

Conversation, turn-taking and reading context, on the person's terms.



Speech & AAC

Clear speech, plus pictures, signs or devices when helpful.



KEY IDEA

**All communication counts: speech, signs,
pictures, devices and behavior.**

Every person deserves a reliable way to be heard.

AAC: another way to talk

- Picture boards and communication books
- Speech-generating apps and devices
- Sign language and gestures
- Useful for full-time or part-time use



Myth: AAC stops speech

Research shows AAC does not hold back speech, and it can support speech development. It also reduces frustration.

How SLPs help with ADHD



Following directions

Strategies for multi-step instructions and listening.



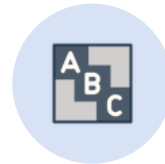
Storytelling & writing

Organizing ideas into a clear beginning, middle and end.



Conversation flow

Turn-taking, staying on topic and repairing misunderstandings.



Reading comprehension

Tracking main ideas and details in longer texts.

Support communication at home

1

Model

Use words, signs or
AAC yourself.

2

Wait

Pause longer than
feels natural.

3

Respond

Honor every attempt
to communicate.

4

Expand

Add one word to
what they said.

Key takeaways

- 1 SLPs support every form of communication, not just speech.
- 2 AAC is a valid way to talk, and it does not stop speech.
- 3 Everyday conversations at home multiply therapy gains.

Look for the credential CCC-SLP (Certificate of Clinical Competence, ASHA).